wanted to declare itself as the leader of the Third World.

Yet, more often the term ‘Third World’ has been used to refer to underdeveloped, less developed and the developing countries and, obviously, the reference point is the developed countries. The goal of the Third World countries is “catching up” with the developed countries. Economically speaking, the First World was defined as the countries with industrialized and free market economies. The Second World countries were those with socialist and centrally planned economies. The Third World countries form the largest group consisting of countries of the three continents of Africa, Asia and Latin America.

Irving Horowitz† also defined the Third World in terms of development in his *Three Worlds of Development.* The First World, made up of Western Europe, USA and Japan was characterized by competitive capitalism. The Second World, that of Soviet bloc, was characterized by socialism of both Soviet and Chinese models. The Third World was made up of those newly independent countries that faced the problems of development belonging to the three continents of Africa, Asia and Latin America.[6]

According to Kegley and Wittkopf[7], “The Third World comprises the poorer, economically less developed countries of the world. So numerous are they that it is easier to say than to say who is not. The underdeveloped countries include all of Asia and Oceania except Japan, Australia and New Zealand, all of Africa except South Africa, and all of the Western Hemisphere except Canada and the United States. Some formulations also include a few European nations in the class of developing economies” like Portugal, Spain, Greece, Turkey, (erstwhile) Yugoslavia and Rumania.

In whatever way one tries to look at the Third World, it would seem to reveal that the Third World is a geo-political concept based on inclusion in a geographical area comprising the Southern hemisphere sharing the common colonial past and put under similar circumstances of underdevelopment. The dismemberment of the Soviet Union and the fast dilution of the socialist model and the socialist bloc has resulted in the gradual disappearance of the Second World and there is a growing tendency of the Second World